

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form (This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.) **Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!**

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) **Tri colored Heron** (Scientific Name) **Egretta tricolor**

Date(s) of occurrence: **April 27, 2001**

Number of birds seen: **one** Sex: ? Plumage: **Breeding**

Exact location: **1/2 mile west of road 18 on the north side of road JJ**

County: **Bent** Nearest town: **Ft. Lyons** Elevation: **3851 feet**

Length of observation: **one - fifteen minute and one five minute** Time(s) of observation: **9:30 to 10:01**

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: **Duane Nelson, Van Truan**

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): **mob**

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: **sunny, wind 10 to 20 mph from the south**

Optical equipment used: **Kowa TSN4, 20 - 60 zoom**

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): **~200 yards**

Was bird(s) photographed? **yes (video)** If so, have you submitted photos? **yes**

Who took the photographs? **Ric Olson**

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: **emerging caitail swamp with many dead snags.**

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): **Resting, preening.**

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes): **This small heron was dark colored on the top and white below. The head was bluish gray with a yellow or golden plumes at the base of the crown. The long pointed bill was blue at the base , getting darker toward the tip. Lores were blue, the eye color was not observed but appeared dark. The chin and 1/3 of the throat were yellow or golden. The rest of the neck was bluish gray extending 1/2 way on to the chest . The other 1/2 of the chest, belly and vent were white. The back and wings were also a bluish gray, except for reddish brown plumes on the lower 1/2 of the back. Leg color was not seen well.**

Describe bird's call or song: **none heard**

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: **Great Blue Heron - gray belly, different color bill and face pattern. Little Blue Heron - dark belly**

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? **I've seen many in Florida**

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): **Sibley Guide to Birds, 2000**

This report is from notes made during **Video** or after observation or later from memory

Date of written report: **May 9, 2001**

Reporting observer: Signature: **Ric Olson 9450 N. Heather Dr., Castle Rock, 80104**

Reporting Observer's Address:

City: State: Zip:

Send report to: Colorado Birds Record Committee c/o Bill Lisowsky 2919 Silverplume Dr. Ft. Collins, Co. 80526